Ru’aun Telegram

9th Edition - October 2027

(Week of 16 Feb 2026)

----- **A Note from the Writers** -----

The Ru'aun Telegram has officially become a monthly newspaper, with the "Ru'aun Today" paper being tasked by the Telegraph for daily reporting as part of cooperation between the Freiberg Journalist Alliance and the Everdusk Journalist Union. This is a response to the busy team at the Telegraph, as the Ru'aun Telegram has faced dramatically longer production times while attempting to keep up with the rapid-fire pace of present-day news. We hope you understand and appreciate the new, more developed format! (Send feedback to aun.telegraph.rua/telegram/feedback/oct)

Out-of-character note: IRP dates will now replace the IRL dates in the Telegram

----- **Scientific News:** Apollo VI, Diana I, and the Stellar Pioneers -----

On 29 March 2026, Apollo V had successfully returned to Gaia, landing on a temporary landing pad west of Astra Porta. The crew would then exit the rocket and board a ship back to mainland Ru'aun, arriving on 2 April 2026. The Chairman of the Ruaunese Workers' Party would greet them, as refugees in Phoenix Drop would meet them firsthand. After the lengthy parade affairs had ended, the National Government would place Apollo VI and Diana I on the back burner as national resources were shifted towards the war effort in Tugana.

By 16 June 2027, the Weltkrieg had ended, and the government would announce the Apollo VI and Diana I missions. This would come with much applause from the RWP, but heavy scepticism from the United Alternative and Libertarian Party. The RWP argued that the government needed to stay vigilant, with Tugana starting its Horizon Programme. However, the UA and LPR emphasise that Ru'aun is overextending its limited resources on a project that does not provide direct benefits to the economy. The United Alternative, in particular, has emphasised that previous space missions by Ausolia were merely vanity projects that would later be abandoned, with the UA highlighting that Ru'aun could fall into the same situation. The debate in Parliament continued, but Parliament was able to push through additional funding for the programme just days before the election. Thus, Apollo VI and Diana I were confirmed, though entangled in political debate.

On 29 September 2027, after a year and a half of delays, the Apollo V crew would board the Starship Apollo 2 and begin their mission to Selene once again. The crew members were Axel Klein, Lucy Klein, Toyohiro Azuma, Aya Kosumosu, Alexander Starfall, Yamada Sakura, Suzuki Ichiro, Marina Sanchez, and Aurora Sanchez. At 21:21, they would launch to the stars.

At the same time, the crew for Diana I would assemble. Lilian Fétique, Sylvaine Berthelot, Mélissa Jacquinot, Alyssa Hernandez, and Guadalupe Araque would all be on the mission's crew, as they would board the Starship Diana 1 with the Solidarity and Emerald modules. At 22:38, the Diana I mission would take flight into Low Gaian Orbit (LGO).

On 30 September 2027, at 03:06, the Diana I mission would reach a sufficiently stable orbit to begin its mission. The Emerald module would be successfully deployed from the Starship's cargo port; it was the Starship's first successful deployment. The Starship would propel the Emerald module as they set up its engines. At 18:36, Mission Control in Phoenix Drop would mark its successful deployment, as the Starship would dock for the night. On 1 October, at 08:14, the crew would awaken to begin the deployment of Solidarity. Solidarity relies on the oxygen and power resources from Emerald. At 17:49, Solidarity would be successfully docked with Emerald, and the Espera Space Station would be deemed operational. The crew would monitor the station for a week, returning to Gaia by 22 October 2027. Diana II is scheduled to deliver a more habitable module for an extended stay.

Apollo VI would land in the Selenite South Pole Crater on the 3rd of October 2027, as the crew would disembark and continue development of the first Selenite base. For the first time, AI-assisted systems would be deployed in space, where AI-powered rovers would assist in constructing the base. While AI has existed for over a decade, its previous forms have been prone to hallucinations. However, recent breakthroughs have reduced the unreliability of the programme and have made strides in its quality. Apollo VI would revolve around the integration of AI-assisted systems in Selenite exploration and development, showcasing Ruaunese advancements in technology.

Apollo VI would begin its return to Gaia on 9 October 2027 and arrive on the 12th, as the National Government continues to pride itself on its advances in space. Despite the successes of the programme, the United Alternative has been the most vocal opponent to the programme; they cite its immense cost and limited benefit to the people of Ru'aun. However, following the advancement of Tugana's Horizon programme, Parliament would come to a consensus that Ru'aun will need to continue the programme if it wants to assert itself as a beacon of innovation.

The Telegraph would approach RASA, the cosmonauts, and many politicians from across the spectrum for input on the programme. The following is what they had to say.

--- *Quotes from the Stars Above* ---

“For what it was intended to achieve, the space programme has been a success. We began with the modest goal of maintaining satellites, and today we place men and women on Selene. That progress has created opportunity both on Gaia and beyond it, supporting factories, engineers, researchers, and countless others whose work makes these missions possible. Space is not separate from society. It reflects the effort and ambition of our people.

At the same time, we must be honest about our limitations. Although our budget is substantial, our institutional structure remains stretched between the demands of Apollo and Diana. The merger of RSRO and RACA brought together agencies that were never originally designed for sustained off-world expansion. We are making responsible use of the resources available to us, but progress comes with costs. If we move too quickly, we risk undermining the stability that has allowed us to succeed.”

-Alexander Hull, RASA Director

“Space is an adventure that many Ruaunese could not have imagined even twenty years ago. We were once dismissed as a backwater, and now we stand on Selene and look back at Gaia with our own eyes. I am proud to serve as a cosmonaut and to be among those working at the frontier of human exploration. I am grateful for the opportunity, not only for myself, but for the communities that believed in a future larger than what we were told was possible. At the same time, I know this work is not symbolic alone. It carries responsibility, discipline, and the understanding that every step forward is built on the effort of countless people at home.”

- Alexander Starfall, Apollo VI Crew

“Space is a remarkable place. For many of us, it represents the hope of humanity and the promise that our future is not confined to a single horizon. These programmes are our effort to move life forward with intention and discipline, to test new technologies and to secure a place for future generations beyond Gaia. I believe that is a goal worthy of national commitment.

The programme has indeed sparked political debate, as any undertaking of this scale should. Different parties weigh costs and priorities differently. Yet Parliament has ultimately recognised that sustained investment in space is not indulgence, but preparation. If we wish to remain resilient and forward-looking as a nation, we must be willing to think beyond the present moment.”
— Cyrus Irons, Ruaunese Workers’ Party Councillor

----- **World News:** Calvera, Weltkrieg, and Deescalation -----

The Calveran War ended on 10 September 2026 through the Treaty of Laconia, marking the end of tensions on the middle-eastern continent. Tyrus would end up keeping Syrvania and Vega under its control, though Ruaunese oversight was heavy. Despite the Ruaunese government’s effort, it failed to account for the ethnic tensions in the region, which resulted in the two-week riots in Rêve. The riots had followed renewed resentment sparked by an invasion of Tyrus by Rigia and Auskia, members of the Ausko-Tugan Federation.

Resentment between Ru’aun and Tugana would come to a head when the Ausko-Tugan Federation invaded Ausolia on the 8th of October 2026, merely months after the end of the Calveran War. Ru’aun would come to the support of its former enemy, putting their shared socialist ideas over past tensions. The decision to join the war, in hindsight, was miscalculated, as Ausolia would collapse quickly, and Ru’aun found itself fighting on the beaches of Tugana. The Tuganan capital was at risk, but their resistance prevented Ruaunese soldiers from marching inland. In the end, Ru’aun would recognise its failures in the war and attempt to negotiate a way out. The Treaty of Neu Freiburg was later signed, as Ru’aun was partially humiliated in its defeat. Despite this, Ru’aun’s only losses were some sparsely populated islands in the Tugan Channel. However, the United Alternative would ramp up its anti-RWP rhetoric in the time following, citing Ru’aun’s presence on Tugan soil as wasted leverage.

In the months following the end of the Weltkrieg, there would be drastic shifts in world politics. Ausolia had collapsed after their defeat, as Tyrus was no longer bound by the Treaty of Laconia’s expansion regulations. As well, following Rigia and Auskia’s invasion of Tyrus, peacekeeping troops from the United Federation of Tugana were asked to withdraw. The newly formed federation would attempt to deny responsibility for its members in its former incarnation, but would eventually be pressured into leaving

the region. Following this, Ruaunese troops would fill the vacuum, as Tyrian troops were barred from entering the rebellious region of Syrvania before ethnic divisions could be worsened.

In summary of the past year of events, the time has been marked by short-lasting peace and geopolitical turmoil. However, political scientists and optimists alike assure the world that there is now peace for our time. For input on how the world is feeling, the Telegraph sent out its journalists to interview people nationwide, and some beyond, and this is what they heard.

--- *Quotes from the World* ---

“Rêve was chaos just a year ago. We still feel the aftershocks of the riots, and you can just feel the tension between the Tyrians and Syrvanians. It’s a real shame that any of that happened, but we’re moving past it. Just because the scars of the past were painful doesn’t mean that they cannot be healed. We are healing those scars a day at a time. In a perfect world, we are not Tyrians, Syrvanians, or Vegans, but Rêveurs. We must stand strong together. We must only hope that we can tread the path upward.”

- Traian Lucescu, Vegan office worker in Rêve, late 2027.

“I can proudly say that life after the war has never been better! We can finally rest easy out here that there will not be a war to catch us by surprise, because the worst is behind us. I can just see the sun shine brighter than ever over our fields! Well, not everything is perfect… I was out in the plaza in Phoenix Drop last week to buy some fertilizer and they were holding a ceremony for our fallen comrades. Of course, it is my moral duty to remember those who died for our country, but it’s a reminder that war has a cost. Perhaps, we can stride the middle ground and find some sort of peace again. Hopefully, the sun never stops shining, and the world continues. Peace for our time, I do pray for.”

- Arman Gomez, Ruaunese farmer, late 2027

“Man, the war was rough. We fought long and hard, but in the end, we must be glad that the struggle is over. The long struggle… it was quite a mess down there in Icarica. Them Tugans fight fiercely, and you have to give them that. Still, I have to ask how we ended up down there. I’m sure proud to have fought for my country, but I still feel the agony watching my comrades fall and the blistering pain of the muddy spring. I’m just glad it’s over, and I pray to Irene that we can stand stronger and smarter coming out of this.”

- Anonymous Ruaunese Soldier, days after the Treaty of Neu Freiberg was signed.

“War is crucial to our survival. Laying down our arms may only make us weaker in the long run. If we, as the Ruaunese people, seek our beloved continuity, we must take arms to defend our eternal civilisation. Sure, offensive wars come at a high cost, but what cost is too great to defend our continuity? We could feel the Tugan capital in reach, and we capitulated first. Worse than that, we lost land despite having leverage on them? Some know me as an expansionist, but it’d be common sense to use that leverage instead of losing strategic islands. We could have had a far better egress from Icarica than the botched mess that happened. Well, what’s done is done. We just need to learn from our mistakes, and hope the mistakes of the past are never repeated.”

- Joseph Rogan, United Alternative Councillor, Advisor to the Rädelsführer, 5 October 2027

“Perhaps the war was a heavily miscalculated one… We were, admittedly, unprepared for another conflict in such quick succession. I would pin the blame on the Ausolians, but I must admit, we may have left our own aggression untamed. War is not inevitable, and we need to be more proactive in preventing these conflicts. For now, we need to focus inward on our own nation and improve the lives of our people. The war economy shouldn’t be perpetual, and making civilian goods should be our number one priority. Science follows when civilians pioneer, and Apollo is our shining beacon of hope in the stars. We turn from perpetual war to improving the quality of life for our citizens, and this starts today.”

- Cyrus Irons, Ruaunese Workers’ Party Councillor, Advisor to Leon Legacy, 7 October 2027